

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

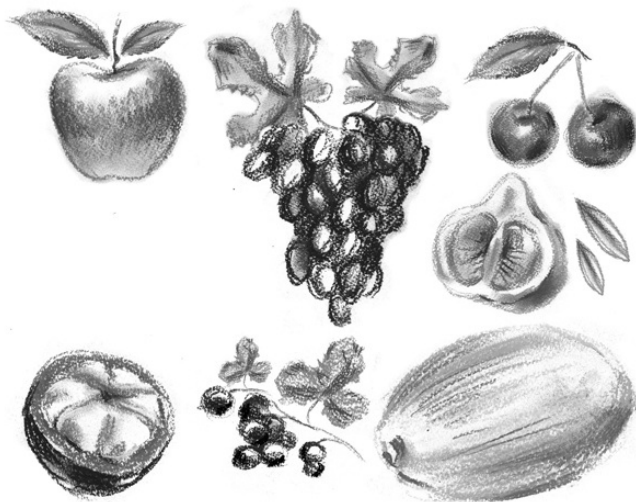
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Let's Start!

How is food genetically modified?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read the labels on food products when you shop?
- What do you know about genetically modified organisms in food?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and subjects of study.
- I can talk about possibility, necessity, and certainty.
- I can explain my opinion.





Let's Explore!

There are proteins in GMOs that are not part of the human **food chain***!

* The "food chain" starts with the sun. For example: sun to grass to cow to meat to human.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

How many of the foods you eat are genetically modified? What potential dangers might we be faced with by eating GMOs?

I am not certain that anyone knows what the long-term effects of eating genetically modified foods could be. One scientist who studies how lab rats are affected by eating GMO potatoes has stated, "In my personal view, increasing research shows that GMOs may actually be very unsafe."

In my opinion, unpredicted allergic reactions could be caused by using proteins from organisms that are not part of the human food chain. For example, corn only suitable for animal feed is found in taco shells. As I see it, we could be harmed by this corn, because it's been genetically modified to contain a toxin that isn't broken down in human gastric systems.

Furthermore, I think that disease-carrying bacteria could be made resistant to antibiotics by genetic modification. Antibiotic-resistant genes are used as 'markers' in GMO crops. These marker genes can be digested by the stomach. The result? We could be infected with antibiotic-resistant bacteria.

So, the next time you buy food, look at the label for GMOs. Consider the statement issued by the British Medical Association saying that antibiotic resistance developing in microorganisms is one major health threat that we will face in the 21st century.





Let's Practice!

You may want to know about genetically modified food.

Instructions: Read article again. Select the correct answer.

1. What have the scientists found out after studying how lab rats are affected after eating GMOs?
 - a. That GMOs may actually be very unsafe
 - b. That GMOs may not be dangerous at all
 - c. That he is not sure about the effects of GMOs
2. According to her, how could unpredicted allergic reactions be caused?
 - a. By eating GMO potatoes
 - b. By eating proteins from organisms that are not part of the human food chain
 - c. By eating taco shells
3. What does she recommend when buying food?
 - a. To look for food without GMOs
 - b. To ask the British Medical Association for help
 - c. To look at the label for GMOs



Let's Practice!

Let's analyze some of the facts regarding GMOs.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write possibility - certainty - no modal verb.

1. I was examined by a doctor. _____
2. You must be informed by the British Medical Association. _____
3. We could be infected by antibiotic-resistant bacteria. _____
4. You can be tricked regarding GMO labels when you check nutrition facts. _____
5. Increasing research shows that GMOs may actually be very unsafe. _____





Extension Activity

Ask questions about GMOs.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read up on GMOs, what they are and how they may affect us.
- Write 5 to 8 questions to ask other people about GMOs.
- Ask 4 people all of your questions.
- Look at the answers and write two or three paragraphs explaining what people do and do not know about GMOs.
- Share your findings with a partner or the class.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about technology and gene modification.

☐ ☐

I ask about possibility, necessity, and certainty of what may happen with GMO food.

☐ ☐

I explain my opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- modified** (adjective): changed in form or character
e.g. How many of the foods you eat are genetically modified?
- resistance** (noun): the ability of an object to not be affected by external factors
e.g. Antibiotic resistance developing in microorganisms is one major health threat that we will face in the 21st century.
- long-term** (adjective): continuing to exist or to have an effect for a long time in the future
e.g. I am not certain that anyone knows what the long-term effects of eating genetically modified foods could be.
- unsafe** (adjective): dangerous
e.g. Increasing research shows that GMOs may actually be very unsafe.
- allergic** (adjective): affected by an allergy
e.g. Allergic reactions are caused by multiple external factors in the environment.
- unpredicted** (adjective): without warning or announcement
e.g. Unpredicted allergic reactions could be caused by proteins from organisms that are not part of the human food chain.
- organism** (noun): a living thing that has the ability to act or function independently
e.g. Organisms that are not part of the human food chain could cause allergic reactions.
- toxin** (noun): a poisonous substance that causes disease
e.g. Usually, genetically modified food contains a great amount of toxins.
- to break down** (verb): to dissolve
e.g. Corn has been genetically modified to contain a toxin that isn't broken down in human gastric systems.





Learning Points

The Passive Voice

You use an active structure when you want the "doer" of the action to be the subject.
You use a passive structure when you want the "receiver" of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = *When you (subject) mix the powder (object) with water, it becomes a potion.*

Passive sentence = *When the powder (subject) is mixed with water, it becomes a potion.*

It is not necessary to mention the subject from an active sentence when it is changed to a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the be verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

am/are/is + past participle

For example:

*Antibiotic-resistant genes **are used** as "markers" in GMO crops.*

Examples:

- *How many of the foods you eat are genetically modified?*
- *For example, corn only suitable for animal feed is found in taco shells.*
- *They contain a toxin that isn't broken down in human gastric systems.*
- *One scientist studies how lab rats are affected after eating GMO potatoes.*





Learning Points

Modal Verbs in the Passive Voice

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs. They come before the dictionary form (Infinitive without *to*) of the main verb.

Modal verbs can add meaning connected with certainty or obligation.

You can use modal verbs in the passive voice.

You use the passive voice when you want to focus on the receiver of the action, rather than the "doer" of the action.

Here is the structure of a passive sentence:

Subject + To be + past participle

For example:

*We **are infected** with an antibiotic-resistant bacteria.*

You can add a modal verb before the To be.

Subject + modal + To be + past participle

For example:

*We **could be** infected with an antibiotic-resistant bacteria.*

Here the sentence now has an additional meaning of possibility, thanks to the modal **could**.

Examples:

- *What potential dangers might we be faced with by eating GMOs?*
- *I am not certain that anyone knows what the long-term effects of eating genetically modified foods could be.*
- *GMOs may actually be very unsafe.*
- *Unpredicted allergic reactions could be caused by using proteins from organisms that are not part of the human food chain.*
- *We could be harmed by this corn, because it's been genetically modified.*
- *I think that disease-carrying bacteria could be made resistant to antibiotics by genetic modification.*
- *These marker genes can be digested by the stomach.*

